

13 Past habits and states

When you talk about habits or states in the past you can use “used to” or “would.” English often uses these forms to contrast the past with the present.

⚙️ **New language** “Used to” and “would”

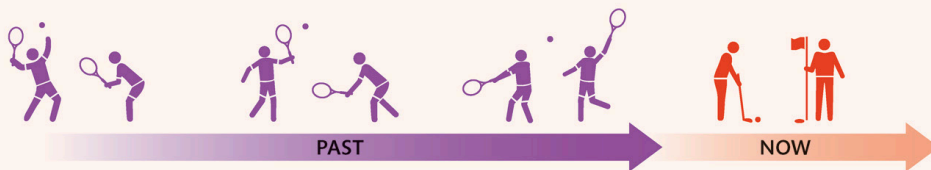
Aa **Vocabulary** Family values

🧩 **New skill** Contrasting the past with the present

13.1 KEY LANGUAGE “USED TO”

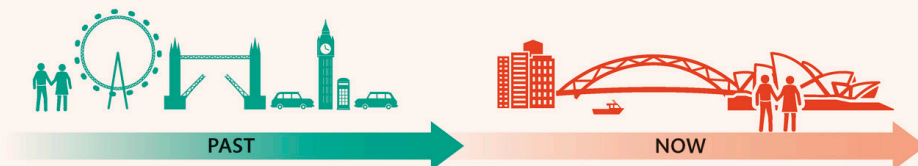
You can use “used to” with an infinitive to talk about past habits.

Refers to a past habit.
We used to play tennis every day, but now we prefer golf.



You can also use it to talk about fixed states at some indefinite time in the past.

Refers to a past state.
We used to live in London before we moved to Sydney.



13.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES “USED TO”



Did you use to ride a scooter when you were a student?



“Used” becomes “use” in the question and negative forms.
I didn’t use to believe in ghosts until I visited a haunted house.



13.3 ANOTHER WAY TO SAY “USED TO” WITH HABITS

You can also use “would” to talk about past habits. It is a little bit more formal.



When I was little, we would go for a picnic every Saturday.



Whenever there was soccer on TV, we just wouldn’t do our homework.

